# Lab 00 — Before Class

*Fifteen minutes at home. Do this and you walk in ready to build.*

## Introduction

Our class together is two hours, and almost all of it is for thinking and building. None of it should be spent installing software.

So everything in this guide happens **before** you arrive. There are four steps, and they take about fifteen minutes.

- **All guides and materials:** gcodekhanna1.github.io/2026-11-enas-agentic-lab. Each guide is a web page, with a PDF version to print or save.
- **One laptop per table.** Your table will build on a single laptop. You don't yet know whose that will be, so **everyone does this setup** — the person driving needs it to work, and the backup needs it when their battery dies.

## What You'll Need

- **A laptop** you can install software on. Mac or Windows both work.
- **Your lab account.** You'll receive an email with a `demo-xx` account assigned to you. Claude's sign-in link is forwarded to the address you normally read, so no new mailbox to check.
- **Your own email**, open in a browser or mail app, to click the verification link.

## Step 01: Create a Folder for Your Project

*Do this before class.*

> ⚠️ **Create this folder in your computer's home folder (the folder with your user name). Do NOT put it in iCloud Drive, Dropbox, OneDrive, Box or Google Drive, and not on your Desktop or in Documents unless you are certain they are not synced. While Claude builds, it writes thousands of small files, and a sync app trying to upload them at the same time will break the build. This is the single most common thing that goes wrong.**

- Create the folder in your **home folder**:
    - **Mac:** in Finder, press **⌘ + Shift + H**. Your home folder opens (for example `/Users/yourname`). Choose **File → New Folder**.
    - **Windows:** in File Explorer, click the address bar, type `%USERPROFILE%` and press **Enter**. Your home folder opens (for example `C:\Users\yourname`). Choose **New → Folder**.
    - Name it something you'll recognize, such as `ENAS 2170 Project`.
- **Quick check:** if the folder's location includes "iCloud", "Dropbox", "OneDrive", "Box" or "Google Drive", move it.

## Step 02: Install the Claude Desktop App

*Do this before class.*

- Install the Claude desktop app from claude.com/download.
    - **Already have it?** Update it to the latest version.
- Open the installer and follow the directions.

## Step 03: Sign In to Your Lab Account

*Do this before class.*

- Open the Claude desktop app and sign in with the `demo-xx@paradigmventures.ai` address from your email.
- Claude emails a verification link. **It arrives in your own inbox**, because your lab account forwards to the address you registered with.
- Open that link **on the same computer** you're signing in from.

[PLACEHOLDER - screenshot of the Claude sign-in screen]

## Step 04: Check That It Works

*Do this before class.*

- In the Claude desktop app, switch to **Cowork** using the control at the top of the sidebar.
- Start a **+ New** session.
- Connect it to the folder you made in Step 01.
- Type a short message — `Hello, can you see my project folder?` — and confirm Claude answers and names your folder.

**That's it.** If all four steps worked, you're done until class.

[PLACEHOLDER - screenshot of a working Cowork session with the project folder connected]

## If Something Doesn't Work

- **The verification email never arrives:** check spam, then email us. Forwarding may need fixing, and that takes a minute to sort out before class rather than during it.
- **You can't install software on your laptop:** tell us before class and we'll sort out an alternative. Don't leave this to the day.
- **Claude can't see your folder:** check it isn't in a synced location (see the warning in Step 01).

## What's Next

In class you'll pick one of three projects and build it with your table:

- **Lab 01 — Volunteer Matching Portal**
- **Lab 02 — Internship Discovery and Planner**
- **Lab 03 — Portfolio and Budget Tracker**

Read them if you're curious, but don't start building. The first half hour of the workshop is for planning on paper, with your laptops closed — and that planning is the part that makes the build work.